# Photography Awards, Competitions & Publication Directory

*Working document — Matt Anthony (mattanthonyphoto.com) Updated: April 3, 2026 Goal: Build credibility toward 2027 magazine publication + Western Living feature*

---

## ACTION ITEMS — NEXT 30 DAYS

| Deadline | Action | Status |
|---|---|---|
| **Apr 17** | Architizer Vision Awards early entry — submit best single image | TODO |
| **Apr 17** | Western Living DOTY — help any designer clients with late entries | TODO |
| **Apr 30** | Architecture MasterPrize early entry ($50 EUR) — submit best exterior + interior | TODO |
| **ASAP** | Create/claim Houzz photographer profile, start uploading projects | TODO |
| **ASAP** | Email Western Living (mail@westernliving.ca) with best project submission | TODO |
| **ASAP** | Register on Designboom and submit strongest unpublished project | TODO |
| **ASAP** | Submit to Dezeen (dezeen.com/submit-a-story/) with exclusive offer | TODO |
| **May 2** | Architecture Photography Awards super early entry | TODO |
| **May 13** | Px3 Paris regular deadline — architecture category | TODO |

## BUDGET SUMMARY

Estimated total for 2026 awards campaign: **~$500-750 USD** across 7-10 entries. One win pays for itself 100x in client credibility.

---

## TIER 1: PHOTOGRAPHY-SPECIFIC AWARDS (Matt enters directly)

---

### 1. Canadian Architect Photo Awards of Excellence

- **Run by:** Canadian Architect magazine (7th year)
- **URL:** canadianarchitect.com/awards/
- **Entry fee:** ~$75 CAD
- **Deadline:** Opens August 1, 2026; closes ~September 12, 2026
- **Categories:** Single best image of a Canadian building (any architect, any era) OR a building outside Canada by a Canadian architect
- **Requirements:** Photo no more than 2 years old, JPEG or TIFF, 300 dpi, 8" largest dimension, photographer name NOT on image
- **What you win:** Publication in December issue of Canadian Architect (print + digital), featured across all platforms
- **Past winners:** Varied — this is the premier Canadian architectural photography award
- **Scope:** National (Canada)
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — Every architect in Canada reads this magazine. A win or shortlist = instant credibility for your entire outreach pipeline. This is your single most important award to enter in 2026.

---

### 2. Architecture Photography Awards (APA)

- **Run by:** Architecture Photo Awards (independent, London-based)
- **URL:** architecturephotographyawards.com
- **Entry fee:** Not published in search results; discounts at early deadlines (15% super early, 10% early)
- **Deadlines:**
- Super early bird (15% off): May 2, 2026
- Early bird (10% off): June 13, 2026
- Final: July 25, 2026
- **Categories:** 23 distinct categories covering the full spectrum of built environment photography
- **What you win:** Grand Prize (Photographer of the Year): EUR 1,000; Category Winners: EUR 100 each; digital certificates, year-long Winner's Gallery feature, media features and editorial spotlights
- **Winners announced:** August 22, 2026
- **Scope:** International
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM-HIGH** — Good prestige, 23 categories means more chances to win. The certificate and gallery feature are useful for proposals and website badges.

---

### 3. Architecture Photography MasterPrize (APMP)

- **Run by:** Architecture MasterPrize / Farmani Group
- **URL:** architectureprize.com/photography-award/
- **Entry fee:** EUR 42 (~$50 USD) per category (professional); EUR 21 (~$25) for students; 30% discount on additional categories
- **Deadlines:**
- Extended early entry (-25%): April 30, 2026
- Regular (-10%): June 30, 2026
- Final: August 31, 2026
- **Categories:** Exterior Architecture Photography, Interior Architecture Photography, plus subcategories
- **What you win:** MasterPrize trophy, Photographer of the Year title, extensive publicity, press campaigns, international book features, Winner Seal for website/print use
- **Past winners:** Franco Casaccia (Interior), Albrecht Voss (Exterior), Victor Romero (Commercial Exterior)
- **Scope:** International
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM-HIGH** — Dedicated entirely to architectural photography. The Winner Seal is useful for marketing. Reasonable entry cost. April 30 early deadline is close.

---

### 4. International Photography Awards (IPA)

- **Run by:** Lucie Foundation (Los Angeles)
- **URL:** photoawards.com
- **Entry fee:** Starts at $40 USD per single image (professional); lower for non-professional/student; discounted add-on categories
- **Deadlines:**
- Early bird (10% off): January 31, 2026 (PASSED)
- Final: June 30, 2026
- **Categories:** Architecture subcategories: Abstract, Bridges, Buildings, Cityscapes, Historic, Interiors, Industrial, Other
- **What you win:** $60,000 total prize pool; Photographer of the Year receives Lucie Trophy + cash; category prizes; curated traveling exhibition
- **Past winners:** Major international names — IPA is in its 23rd edition
- **Scope:** International
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — One of the most respected global photography competitions. Multiple architecture subcategories (Interiors, Buildings) match your work perfectly. Winning or placing = major international credential.

---

### 5. Prix de la Photographie Paris (Px3)

- **Run by:** Px3 (Paris)
- **URL:** px3.fr
- **Entry fee:** EUR 30 per single image (professional); EUR 50 per series (2-8 images); EUR 20/40 for non-professional/student; 20% discount on additional categories
- **Deadlines:**
- Early bird (10% off): February 18, 2026 (PASSED)
- Regular: May 13, 2026
- Final: July 22, 2026
- **Categories:** Architectural is a dedicated category, with Professional and Non-Professional divisions
- **What you win:**
- Photographer of the Year: EUR 5,000
- Best New Talent: EUR 2,000
- First Place Category (Pro): EUR 500
- First Place Category (Non-Pro/Student): EUR 250
- Exhibition in Paris, certificates, global press coverage
- **Scope:** International
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM** — Prestigious French award with good cash prizes. Architecture is a dedicated category. The Paris exhibition adds cachet. Good for international credibility but less recognized in BC/Canada market specifically.

---

### 6. Sony World Photography Awards

- **Run by:** World Photography Organisation
- **URL:** worldphoto.org/sony-world-photography-awards
- **Entry fee:** FREE
- **Deadlines:**
- Open competition: January 6, 2026 (PASSED for 2026)
- Professional competition: January 13, 2026 (PASSED for 2026)
- 2027 edition typically opens June/July 2026
- **Categories:** Architecture is one of 10 Open competition categories
- **What you win:** $5,000 cash, top Sony digital imaging equipment, inclusion in London exhibition at Somerset House + global touring exhibitions
- **2026 winners:** Markus Naarttijarvi (Sweden) for paper mill image; ceremony April 16, 2026 in London; exhibition April 17-May 4, 2026 at Somerset House
- **Scope:** International (massive — 120,000+ votes from 100+ countries)
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — Free to enter, massive global prestige. The 2026 cycle is closed but you MUST enter 2027 when it opens (~June/July 2026). Even shortlisting here is career-defining. Set a calendar reminder.

---

### 7. Arcaid Images Architectural Photography Award

- **Run by:** Arcaid Images, presented at World Architecture Festival
- **URL:** arcaidawards.com / arcaidimages.com
- **Entry fee:** Historically free or low cost
- **Deadline:** Historically ~July (check site — status unclear for 2026)
- **Categories:** Exterior, Interior, Sense of Place, Building in Use
- **What you win:** Exhibited at World Architecture Festival, global press coverage (Dezeen, CNN, ArchDaily have all covered winners)
- **Past winners:** Covered extensively by Dezeen, CNN, Architects' Journal
- **Scope:** International

- **Strategic value: MEDIUM** — Prestigious but status of 2026 competition is unclear. The World Architecture Festival connection gives major exposure if the award is still running. Worth monitoring.

---

### 8. Architizer Vision Awards

- **Run by:** Architizer
- **URL:** visionawards.architizer.com
- **Entry fee:** Not published in search results (check site)
- **Deadlines:**
- Early entry: April 17, 2026 (IMMINENT)
- Submit by July 11, 2026
- **Categories:** Architectural Photography & Video categories — celebrates standout single images; also renderings, drawings, video, concept architecture
- **Requirements:** 1 photograph per entry, max 20MB, JPG/JPEG/PNG, no collages
- **What you win:** Published in Architizer Journal, global exposure to Architizer's architecture audience
- **Scope:** International
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM-HIGH** — Architizer has massive reach in the architecture community. Being published on their platform = visibility to exactly the clients you want. April 17 early deadline is coming fast.

---

### 9. Communication Arts Photography Annual

- **Run by:** Communication Arts magazine (USA)
- **URL:** commarts.com/competition/2026-photography
- **Entry fee:** $40-$180 per entry (professional); $20-$90 (student); $10 late fee per entry after March 13
- **Deadline:** March 13, 2026 (PASSED); late entries until March 27, 2026 (PASSED)
- **Categories:** No dedicated architecture category, but relevant options: Institutional, Self-Promotion, Unpublished
- **What you win:** Publication in the Communication Arts Photography Annual (print + digital + commarts.com), one of the most respected creative publications in North America
- **Scope:** International (US-based)
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — Extremely prestigious in the creative industry. 2026 deadline has passed. Enter the 2027 cycle (typically opens January). A CommArts Annual feature is a major credential.

---

### 10. Graphis Photography Annual

- **Run by:** Graphis Inc. (New York)
- **URL:** graphis.com/competition/photography-awards-2026/entry
- **Entry fee:** $45 single / $70 series (members); $90 single / $140 series (non-members)
- **Deadline:** 2026 Annual submissions closed (final was November 25, 2025). Watch for 2027 cycle.
- **Categories:** Open across all professional photography areas (no dedicated architecture category but architecture work qualifies)
- **What you win:** Platinum, Gold, Silver tiers; winners published in print Annual and permanently archived online; Platinum/Gold get full-page spreads
- **Scope:** International
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM** — Highly respected in the design/creative industry. Permanent online archive is valuable. Enter the 2027 cycle when it opens.

---

### 11. Applied Arts Photography Awards (Canada)

- **Run by:** Applied Arts Magazine (Toronto)
- **URL:** appliedartsmag.com/photography_awards/

- **Entry fee:** Varies by category (download 2026 Categories Kit for pricing)
- **Deadline:** January 30, 2026 (PASSED for 2026 cycle)
- **Categories:** 75+ categories including Architectural, Environmental & Spaces, Corporate, Landscape
- **What you win:** Published in Applied Arts Annual, major Canadian creative credential
- **Scope:** National (Canada)
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — This is the Canadian equivalent of Communication Arts. Architecture is a dedicated category. A win here is recognized by every design firm and agency in Canada. Enter the 2027 cycle.

---

### 12. LensCulture Awards

- **Run by:** LensCulture
- **URL:** lensculture.com/photo-competitions
- **Entry fee:** Varies by competition
- **Deadline:** Art Photography Awards 2026 closed December 17, 2025
- **Categories:** Open theme (no dedicated architecture category, but architecture can be submitted)
- **What you win:** Exhibition in New York during The Photography Show, online feature, international press, cash prizes, career-boosting opportunities
- **Scope:** International
- **Strategic value: LOW-MEDIUM** — More fine-art focused than commercial architectural photography. Not the best fit for your niche but could work for artistic/abstract architectural images.

---

### 13. AIA Los Angeles Architectural Photography Awards

- **Run by:** AIA Los Angeles chapter
- **URL:** aialosangeles.org/home/awards/
- **Deadline:** Call for entries announced early April 2026 (check site NOW)
- **Entry fee:** Non-refundable fee at registration (amount TBD)
- **Categories:** Best Image, Best Rendering, Best Instagram Feed
- **Requirements:** AIA member requirement for submitters (architects), but photography category may differ — check 2026 rules
- **What you win:** AIA recognition, published on AIA LA platforms
- **Past winners:** 13 Best Image recipients + category winners in recent years
- **Scope:** Regional (LA/USA) but nationally recognized
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM** — Directly architecture-focused. "Best Instagram Feed" category is interesting if you build your IG presence.

---

### 14. AIA National Photography Competition

- **Run by:** AIA St. Louis / Design Architecture Center
- **URL:** dcarchcenter.org (check for 2026 listing)
- **Entry fee:** $20 (students/emeritus) to $50 (non-member architects); up to 5 images per entry
- **Categories:** Architectural photography
- **Scope:** National (USA)
- **Strategic value: LOW-MEDIUM** — More US-centric, but affordable and directly relevant.

---

### 15. Archifoto (European Awards of Architectural Photography)

- **Run by:** European architectural photography organization
- **Deadline:** June 1, 2026

- **Scope:** European focus
- **Strategic value: LOW** — European focus, less relevant for BC market positioning.

---

## TIER 2: INDUSTRY AWARDS WHERE PHOTOGRAPHERS GET CREDITED

*These are awards that architects/builders/designers enter, but where the photographer receives credit and publication exposure. Your strategy: make sure your clients enter these and credit you properly.*

---

### 16. RAIC Awards (All Programs)

- **Photographer credited:** YES — photographer names appear in all award announcements and publications
- **Examples:** Scott Norsworthy credited for Ismaili Centre; Henry Woide credited for Clearfell House (2026 winners)
- **Key programs:** Governor General's Medals, Annual Awards, Emerging Practice
- **Action:** Ensure your architect clients credit you when entering. Your name appears in Canadian Architect coverage, RAIC website, and all press releases.
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — A credit line on a RAIC award-winning project is the single strongest credential in Canadian architecture.

---

### 17. Georgie Awards

- **Run by:** CHBA British Columbia
- **URL:** georgieawards.ca
- **Entry fee:** Paid by builder/member
- **Deadline:** November 4, 2025 (for 2026 ceremony)
- **Photography usage:** CHBA BC and Georgie Awards reserve the right to use all submitted photos for promotion. Images are central to judging.
- **Photographer credited:** Not explicitly required in submission guidelines — you need to negotiate credit with your builder clients
- **Action:** Make sure your builder clients (Balmoral, etc.) credit you in their entries. The Georgie Awards gala is May 23, 2026 at Hyatt Regency Vancouver. Attend for networking.
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — Dominant BC builder award. Your photos directly influence whether entries win. Credited photos = builder referrals.

---

### 18. CHBA National Awards for Housing Excellence

- **Run by:** Canadian Home Builders' Association (national)
- **URL:** chba.ca/housing-awards/
- **Photography:** Central to submissions — entries judged on descriptions, images, and documentation
- **Photographer credited:** Not explicitly addressed in public guidelines; credit depends on individual submission
- **Action:** When your builder clients advance from Georgie Awards to nationals, ensure photographer credit is included
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM-HIGH** — National visibility. Finalists get press coverage across Canadian construction media.

---

### 19. Dezeen Awards

- **Run by:** Dezeen (London)
- **URL:** dezeen.com/awards/
- **Entry deadline:** June 3, 2026
- **Photography:** Up to 10 images per entry; at least one completed project photo required; main image must be square

- **Photographer credited:** Dezeen requires project credits in submissions
- **What winners get:** Published on Dezeen (3M audience, 8M social, 500K newsletter); new Regional Showcases for 2026
- **Action:** If any of your architect/designer clients have projects with Dezeen-worthy design, encourage them to enter and credit you. Even shortlisting gets published.
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — Dezeen is the world's most-read architecture publication. A credit on a Dezeen Awards feature is massive.

---

### 20. Azure AZ Awards

- **Run by:** Azure Magazine (Toronto)
- **URL:** awards.azuremagazine.com
- **Photography:** Entrants must credit photographer; photographer name required in image file names when multiple photographers contributed
- **What winners get:** Published in July/August 2026 print + digital issue of Azure Magazine with photographer credits
- **Scope:** International (Canadian-based)
- **Action:** Ensure your clients credit you. Azure is one of the top Canadian architecture/design publications.
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — Credit in Azure Magazine = direct visibility to Canadian architects and designers. Longlist for 2026 already announced for Architecture, Urbanism, Design, and Interiors.

---

### 21. Canadian Interiors Best of Canada Awards

- **Run by:** Canadian Interiors magazine
- **URL:** canadianinteriors.com/best-of-canada-awards-competition/
- **Photography:** Submission form requires photographer name/credit for all photos; credits published in magazine if entry wins
- **Past credited photographers:** Ema Peter (Lantern House), Mackenzie Telenko (product photography)
- **2026 cycle:** Not yet open — submissions announced early 2026
- **Action:** Encourage interior designer clients to enter and credit you
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM-HIGH** — Direct credit in a national Canadian interiors publication.

---

### 22. Western Living Designers of the Year (DOTY)

- **Run by:** Western Living Magazine (Vancouver)
- **URL:** westernliving.ca/doty/
- **Entry fee:** $150 + tax (regular); $175 (April 2-13 late); $275 (April 14-17 final)
- **Deadline:** April 1, 2026 regular; April 17, 2026 absolute final
- **Photography:** All images must be JPG, 300 dpi preferred, under 20MB
- **Publication rights:** Western Living can publish on all platforms including social media
- **Photographer credited:** Yes — photographers are credited in published features
- **Event:** Winners celebrated September 10, 2026 at Inform in Vancouver
- **Action:** THIS IS YOUR #1 PUBLICATION TARGET FOR 2027. Build relationships with designers who enter. Offer to shoot their entries. When your photos appear in the published features, you get credited in Western Living — which directly fulfills your 2027 goal.
- **Strategic value: EXTREMELY HIGH** — Western Living feature is an explicit 2027 goal. The DOTY pathway is the most direct route. April deadlines are NOW.

---

### 23. Interior Design Magazine Best of Year

- **Run by:** Interior Design Magazine / Sandow Design Group (USA)
- **URL:** interiordesign.net (boyawards.secure-platform.com)

- **Entry opens:** ~July 2025
- **Deadline:** ~September 19, 2025 (for 2026 cycle — PASSED)
- **Photographer credited:** Yes — photographers credited in winner coverage (SFAP, Alan Karchmer, Hufton+Crow have been featured)
- **Scope:** International (US-based)
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM** — Major US interior design publication. Less relevant for BC market specifically but good for portfolio prestige.

---

### 24. ArchDaily Building of the Year

- **Run by:** ArchDaily
- **URL:** boty.archdaily.com
- **Process:** Community-voted from projects published on ArchDaily in the prior year
- **Photographer credited:** Yes — image credits appear on all ArchDaily project pages (e.g., "Image (c) David Foessel")
- **2026 stats:** 120,000+ votes from 100+ countries; 15 categories including Houses
- **Action:** Get your projects published on ArchDaily first (see Publication section below), then they become eligible for Building of the Year voting
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM** — Indirect (you don't enter this), but ArchDaily credits are seen by millions of architects worldwide.

---

## TIER 3: PHOTOGRAPHY ASSOCIATIONS WITH AWARD PROGRAMS

---

### 25. CAPIC (Canadian Association of Professional Image Creators)

- **URL:** capic.org
- **What:** National Canadian association for professional photographers and illustrators, founded 1978
- **Awards:** Student competition ("Rodeo") program exists; professional award programs vary by year
- **Membership value:** Industry advocacy, licensing resources, networking with Canadian commercial photographers
- **Action:** Join for networking and industry credibility. Check for 2026 professional competitions.
- **Strategic value: LOW-MEDIUM for awards, MEDIUM for membership** — More valuable for industry connections than competitions specifically.

---

### 26. ASMP (American Society of Media Photographers)

- **URL:** asmp.org
- **What:** Professional association for US-based media photographers; architectural photography is a listed specialty
- **Awards:** Winners featured in printed + digital Sourcebook sent to major editors and agencies; entries receive written judge feedback
- **Action:** Less relevant as a Canadian photographer unless you're actively pursuing US clients
- **Strategic value: LOW** — US-focused. CAPIC is the Canadian equivalent.

---

### 27. APA (American Photographic Artists)

- **URL:** apanational.org/awards
- **What:** Annual competition open to all photographers worldwide; 15 categories + Best of Show
- **Entry fee:** Members save 50% per image
- **Chapter competitions:** APA New York (gallery exhibition at Soho Photo Gallery); APA Los Angeles ("Off the Clock" competition judged by industry leaders)

- **Action:** Enter the national awards if you have a strong standalone image. The New York gallery exhibition is good exposure.
- **Strategic value: LOW-MEDIUM** — Open to international entries but US-centric. Better options exist for your niche.

---

### 28. PDN (Photo District News)

- **Status: DEFUNCT** — PDN ceased publication in January 2020. No longer an active competition.
- **Strategic value: NONE**

---

## TIER 4: PUBLICATION SUBMISSION OPPORTUNITIES

*These are not awards but editorial submissions. Getting published in any of these directly supports the 2027 magazine publication goal.*

---

### 29. Western Living Magazine

- **URL:** westernliving.ca/submit-your-project/
- **How to submit:** Email mail@westernliving.ca with a brief description + photos. Casual/iPhone photos are fine for the initial pitch — they don't need to be print-ready initially.
- **Portfolio submission:** Drop your portfolio off at their office, attention Art Director
- **Who can submit:** Designers, architects, homeowners, or photographers can submit projects
- **What they look for:** Western Canadian homes and design projects
- **Photographer credited:** Yes — photographers are credited in all published features
- **Exclusivity:** Preferred but not strictly required
- **Action plan:**
- Submit your best completed luxury residential project via email
- Include 8-12 images showing full scope of the home
- Brief description focusing on design intent, materials, and the architect/designer story
- Also pursue DOTY pathway (see #22 above) — getting your photos into DOTY entries that win is the most reliable path to a Western Living feature
- **Strategic value: EXTREMELY HIGH** — This is your #1 target publication. Based in Vancouver, covers Western Canada exclusively, reaches every architect/designer/builder in your market.

---

### 30. Gray Magazine

- **URL:** graymag.com/awardsx (GRAY Awards); submissions via Submittable
- **How to submit:** Enter through the GRAY Awards submission portal
- **Requirements:** Projects must be completed/built (not concepts), less than 2 years old, professionally photographed
- **Image specs:** CMYK preferred, JPEG, no watermarks, mix of vertical and horizontal
- **Key criterion:** "Has it been professionally photographed, and will the images look stunning in print?" — photography quality is explicitly evaluated
- **Photographer credited:** Yes — photographer attribution included in all published features
- **Publication:** Print and digital editions of GRAY Magazine + social media
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — Pacific Northwest design magazine. Explicitly values professional photography. Your work in Sea-to-Sky luxury homes is a natural fit.

---

### 31. Dwell Magazine

- **URL:** dwell.com/article/how-to-submit-to-dwell-397833aa
- **How to submit:**
- Email edit@dwell.com with brief description + images
- OR use "Post a Project" on dwell.com to be considered for Editor's Pick
- **What to include:** Project description focusing on distinctive features (sustainability, modular design, affordability), whether it's been published elsewhere, award history, owner willingness to be named/featured
- **Image specs:** Min 800x800px, max 10MB, JPG/PNG/GIF, no filters or artificial enhancement
- **Key:** Dwell prefers EXCLUSIVE projects not seen elsewhere (including blogs). Smart design that serves inhabitants.
- **Photographer credited:** Not always — for major features, Dwell sends their own staff photographer and writer
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM** — Major international publication but very competitive. They prefer exclusives and may send their own photographer for accepted features. Better as a secondary target after Western Living and Gray.

---

### 32. Architectural Digest (AD)

- **URL:** No direct submission portal — email pitch with "PROJECT SUBMISSION" in subject line (caps)
- **How it works:** Pitch one publication at a time (exclusivity required). If accepted, AD sends their own staff photographer and writer — the submitter does NOT photograph or write the article.
- **What to include:** Best single project, interesting backstory, visually striking, well-designed
- **Response time:** 2-4 weeks; follow up after one month
- **Photographer credited:** Only their staff/assigned photographers shoot accepted features
- **Strategic value: LOW for photographer credit** — AD uses their own photographers. However, if you or a client pitch a project and it gets accepted, the exposure is massive. Not a direct path to getting YOUR photos published there.

---

### 33. Dezeen (Editorial Submissions)

- **URL:** dezeen.com/submit-a-story/
- **How to submit:** Email a selection of good JPEGs (min 3000px shortest side) + text about the project + links
- **Photography policy:** Dezeen rarely pays for photography but gives full credits, links, and copyright details. "Many photographers happily give Dezeen free imagery as publication is a good way to promote their work and often leads to commissions."
- **Key tips:** Offer exclusivity (makes selection more likely). Include plans/sections. Content must be fresh, innovative, newsworthy with fantastic images.
- **Photographer credited:** YES — always credited with links
- **Who can submit:** Anyone — firms, photographers, PR agencies
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — Dezeen credits photographers prominently. A Dezeen publication credit is seen by millions. You can submit directly as the photographer. Focus on your most design-forward projects.

---

### 34. ArchDaily

- **URL:** archdaily.com/submit-a-project
- **How to submit:** 2-step form; upload all documents and visuals to Dropbox/Google Drive folder, paste link
- **Image specs:** Minimum 15 images, at least 2880px width, shot by specialized architectural photographers
- **Photographer credited:** YES — ArchDaily is committed to crediting all contributors including photographers. Credits must be clearly included in submissions.
- **Who can submit:** Typically architects/firms submit, but photographer is credited
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM-HIGH** — Massive global reach. Getting credited on ArchDaily projects builds your searchability and portfolio. Work with your architect clients to submit their best projects.

---

### 35. Designboom

- **URL:** designboom.com/readers-submit/
- **How to submit:** Register, then upload up to 12 images + English text per submission
- **Image specs:** Greater than 800px width; include sketches, process photos, plans
- **Key tips:** Unpublished work has better chance. Give Designboom exclusivity for a couple of days. Articles can be published within hours.
- **Audience:** 3.5M monthly readers (professionals, students, design enthusiasts)
- **Photographer credited:** Credits included in published features
- **Strategic value: MEDIUM** — Large audience, fast turnaround. Good for getting projects out quickly.

---

## TIER 5: BEST OF HOUZZ (PLATFORM-BASED)

---

### 36. Best of Houzz — Photography

- **Run by:** Houzz
- **URL:** houzz.com/best-of-houzz
- **Entry fee:** Free (no application — automatically evaluated)
- **How it works:** Badges awarded to the top 2% of 3M+ professionals on Houzz. Photography badge goes to photographers whose images were most saved to Ideabooks by users in the past year.
- **Deadline:** None — based on prior calendar year activity. 2026 winners announced ~January 2026.
- **How to win:**
- Create/claim your Houzz professional profile as an architectural photographer
- Upload large, high-quality images of every completed project
- Write complete descriptions with keywords and facets
- Upload projects as soon as they're completed (maximize save time)
- Consistent uploading throughout the year
- **What you win:** Best of Houzz badge (Design, Service, or Photography); displayed on your profile; major social proof for prospective clients
- **Strategic value: HIGH** — Free, builds passive leads, the badge is recognized by homeowners and designers who hire photographers. Start uploading to Houzz NOW to qualify for 2027 badge.

---

## ANNUAL CALENDAR: KEY DEADLINES

| Month | Award/Submission | Action |
|---|---|---|
| **April 2026** | Western Living DOTY late entry (Apr 17) | Help clients with entries NOW |
| **April 2026** | Architizer Vision Awards early entry (Apr 17) | Enter best single image |
| **April 2026** | Architecture MasterPrize early entry (Apr 30) | Enter best exterior + interior |
| **May 2026** | Architecture Photography Awards super early (May 2) | Enter across multiple categories |
| **May 2026** | Px3 Paris regular deadline (May 13) | Enter architecture category |
| **June 2026** | Architecture Photography Awards early (Jun 13) | Final chance for discount |
| **June 2026** | Dezeen Awards (Jun 3) | Encourage clients to enter + credit you |
| **June 2026** | IPA final deadline (Jun 30) | Enter Buildings + Interiors subcategories |
| **June 2026** | Architecture MasterPrize regular (Jun 30) | Backup if you missed April |
| **June/July 2026** | Sony World Photography Awards 2027 opens | ENTER IMMEDIATELY when it opens |

| Month | Award/Submission | Action |
|---|---|---|
| **July 2026** | Architecture Photography Awards final (Jul 25) | Last chance |
| **July 2026** | Px3 Paris final (Jul 22) | Last chance |
| **July 2026** | Architizer Vision Awards final (Jul 11) | Last chance |
| **August 2026** | Canadian Architect Photo Awards opens (Aug 1) | YOUR MOST IMPORTANT ENTRY |
| **August 2026** | Architecture MasterPrize final (Aug 31) | Last chance |
| **September 2026** | Canadian Architect Photo Awards deadline (~Sep 12) | Submit best Canadian building image |
| **Fall 2026** | Applied Arts Photography Awards 2027 | Watch for call for entries |
| **Fall 2026** | Graphis Photography Annual 2027 | Watch for call for entries |
| **January 2027** | Communication Arts Photography Annual 2027 | Watch for call for entries |
| **Ongoing** | Upload to Houzz consistently | Build toward 2027 Best of Houzz badge |
| **Ongoing** | Submit to Dezeen, ArchDaily, Designboom | Build publication portfolio |

---

## RECOMMENDED ENTRY STRATEGY (2026)

### Must Enter (Non-Negotiable)

1. **Canadian Architect Photo Awards of Excellence** (Aug-Sep) — $75, highest ROI in Canada
2. **Sony World Photography Awards 2027** (opens Jun/Jul) — FREE, massive global prestige
3. **Best of Houzz** — FREE, start uploading now for 2027 badge

### High Priority

1. **IPA Architecture** (Jun 30) — ~$40+, multiple subcategories, strong international credential
2. **Architecture Photography MasterPrize** (Apr 30 early) — ~$50, dedicated arch photo award
3. **Architecture Photography Awards** (May 2 early) — 23 categories, good odds
4. **Architizer Vision Awards** (Apr 17 early) — architecture-specific audience

### Medium Priority

1. **Px3 Paris** (May 13 regular) — ~$30+, good cash prizes
2. **Applied Arts Photography Awards 2027** (~Jan 2027) — Canadian creative credential
3. **Communication Arts Photography Annual 2027** (~Jan 2027) — major creative credential

### Publication Submissions (Ongoing)

1. **Western Living** — Submit your best project by email ASAP
2. **GRAY Magazine** — Submit through GRAY Awards portal
3. **Dezeen** — Email strongest project with exclusive offer
4. **ArchDaily** — Work with architect clients to submit
5. **Designboom** — Register and start submitting

### Client-Driven (Ensure Your Credit)

1. **RAIC Awards** — Make sure architect clients credit you
2. **Georgie Awards** — Make sure builder clients credit you

3. **Azure AZ Awards** — Make sure clients credit you
4. **Western Living DOTY** — Shoot entries for designer clients
5. **Dezeen Awards** — Encourage clients to enter and credit you
6. **Canadian Interiors Best of Canada** — Ensure credit in submissions

---

## ESTIMATED BUDGET

| Award | Fee | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| Canadian Architect Photo Awards | ~$75 CAD | Must |
| Sony World Photography Awards 2027 | Free | Must |
| Best of Houzz | Free | Must |
| IPA (2-3 subcategories) | ~$120-160 USD | High |
| Architecture MasterPrize (2 categories) | ~$63 EUR (early) | High |
| Architecture Photography Awards (3-4 categories) | ~$100-150 EUR est. | High |
| Architizer Vision Awards (1 entry) | ~$50-100 USD est. | High |
| Px3 Paris (2-3 images) | ~$60-90 EUR | Medium |
| **Total estimated:** | **~$500-750 USD** | |

This is a highly efficient spend. One win pays for itself 100x in client credibility and referral value.

---

## KEY INSIGHT: THE 2027 PUBLICATION PATHWAY

Your 2027 goal is to be published in an architectural magazine and featured in Western Living. Here is the clearest path:

1. **April-May 2026:** Help designer/architect clients with Western Living DOTY entries. Your photos appear in published features = Western Living credit.
2. **May-August 2026:** Enter 5-7 photography awards with your best images. Even one win = "Award-winning architectural photographer" credential.
3. **August-September 2026:** Enter Canadian Architect Photo Awards. A win = December 2026 publication in Canada's premier architecture magazine.
4. **Ongoing 2026:** Submit strongest projects to Dezeen, ArchDaily, Gray Magazine. Build a track record of published work.
5. **September 2026:** With awards + publications in hand, pitch Western Living directly with a compelling project + your credentials.
6. **January 2027:** Enter Sony World Photography Awards, Communication Arts, Applied Arts, Graphis for the 2027 cycle.
7. **By mid-2027:** You should have 2-4 publication credits + 1-2 award wins = "Published, award-winning architectural photographer" positioning.

The investment is ~$500-750 in entry fees and the time to prepare strong submissions. The return is a fundamentally different market position.